How to Cope with Social Anxiety Disorder

Ngoc Bao Khanh Duong

CLOCAL FOUNDATION

November 15, 2023

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The world's third most common mental health disorder in the world is presented as a form of anxiety. Undoubtedly, stress can make people feel anxious. Particularly, disproportionate amounts of anxiety can sometimes be caused by an underlying issue, most commonly, social anxiety disorder. Social anxiety disorder is a type of fear in social situations caused by many different reasons. At the present time, social anxiety disorder becomes a serious endangerment to the control of the interaction in human's day-to-day activities and also known as the world's third most common mental health disorder. This research paper aims to study the traumatic and difficult life experiences in childhood related to the development of social phobia. In order to solve this challenge, this research paper focuses on relevant solutions to boost the self-esteem and promote communication skills in each individual.

Social Anxiety Disorder

Social anxiety disorder (SAD), formerly called social phobia, is characterized by a prolonged dread of worry and severe interpersonal limitations in social interactions such as meeting new people or shying away from engaging with others altogether. Those who have SAD usually try to avoid expressing their opinion, talk about safe or neutral topic, or reflected defensive attempts to distance themselves from others such as pretending to be busy doing something else or acting somewhat hostile. Individuals with SAD may have few friends, disturbances in school performance, difficulties with intimate relationships, and alcohol use. Social anxiety disorder constitutes the prevalence of illness in the part of the world and possibly have a propensity for a growth in recent and future.

Social Anxiety Roots

Psychological Trauma in Lifetime

It can be stated that growing up with psychological trauma in childhood can automatically result in social anxiety disorder. The traumatic experience must be related to concern about being negatively evaluated by others, or being bullied humiliatingly, leading to possible embarrassment and shyness. Insulting and denigrating when making mistakes can bring children's negative emotion toward the parents' attitude. Alessandri and Lewis (1993) report that negative evaluations and lack of positive evaluations by the parents are associated with children's expression of shame and sensitivity in the face of people's criticism (pp. 335–343). In some reasons, using shame as a form of discipline rather than motivating a child to change and better themselves can make them feel like they are not capable of doing that. For both children and adults, the effects of shame can manifest in not wanting to socialize with others for fear of judgment, and often stopping doing the things a person love for the same reason. In short, it is the repeated pattern of behavior or extreme incident that expresses to children that they are worthless, or unloved, that can cause the lasting damage to their selves and their psyches.

Environmental Factors in Children

Not only psychological experiences, but also the environmental factors associated with social anxiety of children, including being isolated socially by parental defense. Particularly, multiple factors may contribute to social anxiety, including overprotection, which may prevent children from learning social skills. Nathason (1992) notes that parents tend to reject or overprotect to their children's autonomous behavior so that the child learns to associate independence with worry and shame. Indeed, as a parent, they want to protect their children from physical factors such as pain, and harm from bad experience (being cheated, lost, accident...), and emotional factors like hurt feelings, and disappointments. However, overprotecting your children can be

detrimental to them socially and developmentally. Children who have been overprotected often do not have to learn to solve their own problems and be nervous to face even small matters. As a result, they may lack emotional maturity and the life skills necessities. In brief, basic limitation from this factor will cause poor problem-solving skills and lack of interaction with society, leading to social anxiety disorder in adulthood for children.

Impacts of Social Anxiety Disorder

The negative effects from a period of greater vulnerability to social anxiety can cause the public self-destruction and the extreme mental manifestations in social interactions. Basically, people with social anxiety disorder regularly struggle with psychological disturbances, including experiencing excessive evaluative fears and heightened self-conscious emotional reactivity. Stopa and Clark (1993) discuss that people with social phobia had more negative self-evaluative thoughts. People who suffer from social anxiety may believe that if others perceive them blushing, it will be considered that they are nervous, weak, or foolish (pp. 255-267). In this case, SAD patients are commonly afraid that people will think badly of them or that they will not measure up in comparison to others. People with SAD try to put themselves in others' position and assume that people may see them in the same negative way that they see themselves. Sadly, those with SAD not only do not believe in their own capacity, but also do not trust the others' praise.

One causal explanation for the high proportion of unhealthy lifestyles in SAD patients is that individuals with SAD define that using alcohol too much is a reasonable way to reduce their anxiety and make them feel better. Social phobia is associated with the promotion of the pathological use of alcohol. Billing & Moos (1983) reveal that people use alcohol because the pharmacological or psychological effects of alcohol and some drugs serve to decrease aversive

anxiety symptom. However, stressful events following alcoholism treatment appear to promote relapse (pp. 205-218). Obviously, alcohol is considered a technique to decrease stress by most of adolescence and it also provides satisfaction and relax in a great extent, but this temporary method is considered to decline fear of embarrassment rather than completely minimizing social phobia. Notably, the method can devastate the body when consuming too much and creating more anxiety as humans cope with their symptoms even though this habit primarily minimizes some social phobia symptoms.

Three Categories of Social Anxiety Disorder

Social anxiety disorder is mainly divided into three extent groups: mild, moderate, and extreme. According to NIH, the large majority (73.3%) of subjects were classified as low scorers, 9 % as medium scorers and 17.7 % as high scorers (2001). To begin with, a spectrum of social anxiety is often indicated by fears in the lower or "mild" categories. Low level social anxiety patients often experience social apprehension related to public speaking, attending meetings or classes, and being the focus of attention. Alongside, individuals who experience higher levels of social phobia have been found to perceive everyday social events as more threatening, which can seriously result in social isolation. Cacioppo et al. (2014) point out that the hypervigilance to social threats experienced by individuals with higher social anxiety can lead to avoidance of others and to feelings of loneliness (pp. 3-21). That is, heightened stress and anxiety responses of being afraid of others' judgments, and social rejection are the principal elements of the cause of loneliness. Undeniably, a person has the worst social anxiety symptoms over a protracted length of time, their anger, disappointment, and sense of powerlessness may drive them to the breaking point, particularly depression.

Essential Methods

Apparently, cognitive model of social anxiety includes excessive self-focus, ruminative thinking, and use of self-protective avoidance strategies and safety behaviors render people unable to implement social skills effectively within anxiety provoking social contexts. Therefore, treatment for SAD frequently starts with targeting social anxiety and avoidance through strategies such as graduated exposure, reducing avoidance safety behaviors, and challenging the negative self-beliefs that perpetuate fear. In order to feel safe in taking risks, attending to social organizations is the first step for those who are afraid of social interactions**.** Workshops or voluntary programs are advocated to meet new people and also to gain practical experiences for people with SAD. For instances, Social Skills Training: Enhancing Social Competence With Children and Adolescents (SST) not only creates favorable conditions for the cure of social anxiety disorder but also contributes to the comprehensive growth of the patients. People who are involved in the treatment are taught relaxation techniques, social problem-solving skills, techniques for positive thinking, as well as being exposed to social conditions.

The second step to enhance the effective communication is to practice communication by themselves, or with others. Having a conversation with strangers is the most common method to reduce anxiety in social interaction for those with SAD. Moreover, people with SAD can get support from the Social Anxiety Group. Participants in the program can connect with others going through similar issues and share their experiences to help each other recover from their illnesses. This treatment also contains assignments and exams to increase the interaction among participants and gradually reduce anxiety. Generally, individual and social methods not only help people to recognize their disadvantages in social interactions, but also encourage them to have the bravery to step outside of their comfort zone.

In addition to self-changing behavior, it is crucial for parents to pay more attention to their offspring. In an effort to persuade parents to nurture children's positive emotions, Garcia-Lopez (2013) clarifies that parental rearing focused on positive communication rather than expressing negative emotions, hostility, and criticism toward children, being able to strengthen their children's sense of security. Actually, if parents spend their time in talking and focusing on their offspring, children may not feel lonely. Giving compliments and talking to that child may render them able to feel encouraged instead of being negative about their child's mistakes. Furthermore, parents not only spend time with their children but also possibly apply to Social Effectiveness Therapy for Children program for their kids. This program is designed to lessen social anxiety by enhancing social abilities and encouraging engagement in social activities, showing aa considerable improvement in functioning and a reduction in symptoms.

In conclusion, social anxiety disorder (SAD) is a tough challenge. However, with the right methods and techniques, including looking at positive achievement, and being satisfied with all types of comments, good and bad, SAD can be overcome. Honestly, no one can guarantee that most people can completely overcome social anxiety with these methods and techniques. However, a little change like eliminating negative thoughts and fear when communicating with others can be minimized gradually.

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